Living Out

By Lisa Loomer

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: ***ACTRESS 1****: Ana, Linda, Richard, Zoila*
ACTRESS 2: *Sandra, Wallace, Nancy, Bobby*
NOTE: Ana, Sandra, Zoila and Bobby are Latinx

ANA: **(Pg 50)** Hola!

SANDRA: Hola muchacha, como estas?

ANA: Ay dios mio! **(Pg 51-52)** I got my appointment with immigration! So what did you do when you made your citizenship? **(Pg 50)** What did they ask you on that test?

SANDRA: Everything! What day is Fourth of July? What Thursday is Thanksgiving? How many stars have the flag? How many stripes? **(Pg 51)** Ay, mija, I got to get a new job. Linda is very nice. But the twins? Yesterday they was playing firemen? They put the couch on fire. And I got three kids when I get home, too! And my son that come from Mexico? Last night the come home with a tattoo!

ANA: Entiendo. I keep missing Santi's soccer practice because I got to work. He's real good at soccer. The uniform! I sent one to Tomas too!

SANDRA: Que bueno. You going to bring him real soon.

ANA: **(Pg 52)** Sabes que? Maybe I should tell Nancy about my son. She's a woman too, no? She's a mother –

SANDRA: **(Pg 53)** *(Shakes her head no)* They're not like us mija. Wait till you get your citizenship. *(checks her watch)* Ooeey – the twins! *(Sandra leaves)*

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INTRODUCTION

AS AN INFOMERCIAL

ACTRESS 1: ***HOLA NANNIES*** *was created for families who need a reliable, nurturing, punctual and experienced nanny to look after their little ones.*
ACTRESS 2: *This could be for working mothers, appointments that you can't miss or if you just need some well-deserved child-free time.*
ACTRESS 1: *Our added advantage is that our bilingual nannies can teach your children a second language!*
ACTRESS 2: *After all, motherhood is universal – a common language that crosses all boarders!*
ACTRESS 2: *Call today and let us know if you need a nanny for living in or for . . .*
TOGETHER: *Living Out by Lisa Loomer*

******Flashback to nanny interviews *******

WALLACE (Interview 1): **(Pg 7-8)** I'm Mrs. Breyer, come in . . . come in . . *(Wallace takes out her palm pilot (ie ipad)* Now, you were interested in living in or living out?

ANA: Living out. *(Eager to get the job)* The agency told me . . .

WALLACE: That's all right. I'm seeing both. So, tell me about yourself. Where are you from?

ANA: Do you know Huntington Park?

WALLACE: No, I meant, where are you – *(gestures)* ***from***?

ANA: Oh. I was born in El Salvador.

WALLACE: Good God, everyone is from El Salvador these days! *(laughs)* What happened to all the Mexicans? *(After an awkward beat)* **(Pg 9)** So I would need you to come by eight. Now, I understand that different cultures have different concepts of time, so I want to be clear that "by eight" . . . I mean "by eight o'clock." Oh – by the way, I would prefer you speak to the children solely in English. *(Looks at Ana's jeans)* And no jeans. Do a little light cleaning – just the kids' rooms and the family room and the kitchen . . . I'm usually home by five or six.

ANA: *(smiles hesitantly)* Okay . . . *(beat)* But . . . you don't want to say a regular time – like maybe – I work till five?

WALLACE: No. I need someone who's flexible. Is that a problem?

ANA: No . . . Is just -- I have to pick up my son at –

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WALLACE: *(sighs)* You have a child?

ANA: **(Pg 11)** Just one in this country. My other son is in El Salvador

WALLACE: **(Pg 9)** *(exasperated)* I specifically told the agency not to send me anyone with a child.

LINDA (Interview 2): Oh, you have children? **(Pg 11)** We had a nanny with a young child – she got sick all the time . . . I'm sorry, Ana. I need someone who can make ***my*** kids a priority.

NANCY (Interview 3): Do you have kids?

ANA: I have two boys. *(Long beat)* But they are both in El Salvador.

******* Scene*******

WALLACE: **(Pg 16-17)** *(to audience)* . . . and for the first week or so, I'll just leave a little cash on the kitchen counter – like I've just – left it, you know . . . And when I get home, I'll count it and see how much is gone. If it's just a little change, well, no bigee . . . But if it's a dollar a – and she doesn't say anything – the next time anything is missing, be it a dollar or a yogurt – I'll mention it. Casually. I'll just say "Gee didn't I buy two cherry yogurts?" And if she does't say, "Oh – I took one for lunch" -- then I have to fire her.

******* Scene – 1st Day on the Job with Nancy*******

NANCY: **(Pg 18-19)** *(jostling the baby while on the phone with work)* Just wanted you to know I've looked over the contract and I'll be in by ten . . . I'm thrilled to be back! *(she hangs up and turns to the baby)* Mommy's only going out for a little while . . . Just an itty bitty while. *(Ana enters)* Oh, Ana! I left a list of number by the phone in case of an emergency. Here. *(still jostling the baby, she points as she reads aloud)* My cell . . . her doctor . . . nearest hospital.

ANA: *(Smiles; covering offense)* I know how to read, Mrs. Robin. I went to school. To be a dentist.

NANCY: You're a – dentist?

ANA: I couldn't finish . . .

NANCY: Oh. Of course. Because of your children . . .

ANA: **(Pg 20)** Because of the war.

NANCY: *(feeling guilty)* Right! *(checks watch)* Well, I really should go.

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ANA: **(Pg 19)** *(Ana takes the baby; Nancy lets her go with enormous difficulty)* I know it's hard to leave her. It was the same for me with *(carefully)* my babies.

NANCY: *(Feeling guilty)* Oh God. And you had to leave them in another country! I'm just going across town . . . And don't worry, if I'm a little late, my husband can always write you a check.

ANA: Oh . . . Mrs. Robin . . . Do you think you could make it cash?

NANCY: You don't have a bank account? *(Ana doesn't answer)* Ana, you're not . . . illegal are you? Oh God, I can't believe I didn't – I was in such as rush to . . .

ANA: I am getting the green card, Mrs. Robin. Don't worry.

*******Scene – In the park with the nannies*******

SANDRA: **(Pg 29)** *(sneezes)* My daughter give me her gripa. Linda keep telling me, "take her to the doctor! Take her to the doctor!" Then she tell me, don't come tomorrow, she don't want Jackson to catch nothing *("et cetera")* la la la . . This could cost me two hundred dollars!

ANA: **(Pg 30-31)** One day we should all stay home!

SANDRA: Everybody! The waiters, the parking peoples, the cleaners –

ZOILA: Los Americanos be driving around in their dirty clothes – starving. Can't go to a restaurant – there's nobody to wash the plate! You get home, the house is a mess –

ANA: The plants is all dead –

SANDRA: Nobody to deliver you pizza –

ZOILA: And then you got to take care of your own kids! *(They all laugh)* Pues . . . I see you tomorrow, mijas. *(Zoila exits)*

ANA: *(beat, then confides in Sandra)* Mira. My little one is here. But I told Mrs. Robin . . .

SANDRA: *(Nods, understanding)* Entiendo. Oye, the only reason I got hired is I got my mother-in-law living with me to watch my girls. How old are your kids?

ANA: Santiago is six. And Tomas is eleven – my son that's in El Salvador

SANDRA: How long since you seen him?

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ANA: Eight years *(beat)* But I talk to him every week. I just sent my grandmother money to get their own phone.

*******Scene*******

ANA: **(Pg 35)** *(on the phone with Tomas)* Tomas? Soy mami! How is school? Then you got to study a little harder, Tomas, so when you come here you know your math . . . Do you miss me? . . . I miss you up to the sky! . . . You're going to come real soon, mijo. *(surprised)* No, no not for vacation – you're going to come here to live! *(beat)* Don't you want to be with Mami? . . . Oye, did you get the pictures I sent you from the beath? With the rides? *(laughs)* Te gustan? That's me and my sister-in law and her friend. *(Pause; fighting tears)* No, mijo . . . I'm the one in the middle.

*******A few weeks later*******

At the Robin's home. Ana is straightening up in the kitchen. She turns on the radio to Latin music and starts to dance. Nancy enters; she appears sick and exhausted.

ANA: *(Surprised)* **(Pg 53)** Nancy?

NANCY: **(Pg 13)** I'm on "The Mommy Track." I won't have a prayer in hell of making partner – *(laughs)* What have the last sixteen years of my life been for?

ANA: **(Pg 53-54)** Can I get you something? Some chamomile tea?

NANCY: *(Nancy starts to cry)* I'm sorry, I don't know why I'm . . . I didn't get much sleep . . . Jenna just kept crying and crying and drying. Richard thinks she's angry I'm gone so much. *(laughs/cries)* Well, clearly he's angry . . . *(quoting Richard)* I have the right to do it all – and not do any of it very well.

ANA: I know. You got stress –

NANCY: No, you've got stress. I mean, you don't even get to see your kids! You know what? I should just call up right now. Quit and take care of my own child.

ANA: *(Shocked; blurts)* No, Nancy! No!

NANCY: *(Taken aback)* Wow. You must think I'm a really lousy mother.

ANA: You're a good mother, Nancy. And Jenna is fine . . . a very lucky child. And – you like to work.

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NANCY: I do like to work! And I love my child! Is that so horrible of me?

ANA: You know what? I like to work too! *(laughs)* Ay, don't tell that to my husband. In my country, all the women is suppose to love to stay home. *(beat)* I tell you a secret, I want to go back to school. . .

NANCY: **(Pg 55)** *(Phone rings and she answers, instantly professional and peppy)* Diane? Hi, I just walked in . . . Tonight? *(surprised)* He did? Dinner?! No, no, I understand . . . **(Pg 56)** I'll call you right back *(she hangs up)* Ana . . . could you work late tonight? I know, it's ridiculously short notice. It's just this director is impossible to pin down. Richard's working late. There's really no one else.

ANA: Jenna is getting a cold –

NANCY: I know. But believe me, my boss does not want to hear about Jenna. I'll be back by nine.

ANA: I . . . guess I could call my husband *(getting her cell phone from her bag as Nancy exits to get dressed)(into phone)* Bobby? Listen, the senora asked me to work late. I know I promised, but I'll see his next game. *(long beat . . . she hangs up sadly)*

*******Later that night*******

ANNA: **(Pg 57)** *(Ana is giving Jenna a bottle)* Okay, Jenna . . . That's my good girl. Duermete con los angeles . . . *(her cell phone rings)* Hallo? . . . Que? . . . I can't understand you Bobby, slow down. *(very still)* Okay . . . Okay, Bobby . . . Okay. *(she hangs up)* Mierda! *(she scribbles a note and leaves it on the table and runs out with Jenna)*

NANCY: **(Pg 58)** *(Nancy arrives home)* Ana . . . Ana? It's ten o'clock! *(she looks in the baby's room, then frantically to the kitchen where she finds a note)* "Emergency. Gone to hospital. Okay." *(Nancy panics; she calls Ana on her cell)* Answer, damn you! **(Pg 59)** *(finally Ana picks up)* Ana? What happened to Jenna!?

ANA: *(on her cell)* Jenna is fine – *(beat, cries out)* It's my child, Nancy. My child!

*******Scene *******

WALLACE: **(Pg 60-61)** *(gossiping indignantly)* Linda, she took Nancy's baby –

LINDA: What? No!

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WALLACE: She was taking care of the baby the other night – and something happened – so she was taking the baby with her to the hospital –

LINDA: The hospital!? Oh, my God. Was there a note?

WALLACE: Note shmote, Linda. She took the baby out of the house. She was driving around without a valid license – with Nancy's child!

LINDA: But her own child was in the hospital?

WALLACE: A child Nancy didn't even know about! A child who was supposedly in El Salvador!

LINDA: *(cries out)* What difference does it make?! It's a child! *(beat of silence)* Is the child going to be all right?

WALLACE: *(The question stops Wallace. She's horrified she never asked)* I . . . don't know. I didn't ask about the child.

*******Scene *******

NANCY: **(Pg 62)** If I hadn't asked her to work late . . .

RICHARD: You were paying her to work late. You were working. Ana was working. Everyone's working and paying someone else to take care of their child. It's insane. *(Beat)* Is it your fault her son had an asthma attack? Is it your fault they took him to the nearest lousy clinic before getting to a real hospital?

NANCY: Doesn't asthma have something to do with . . . stress? If he was expecting his mother and . . .

RICHARD: *(interrupting)* What are we going to do about Jenna? What if Ana doesn't want to come back? Do you want to call the agency about a new nanny?

NANCY: **(Pg 63)** *(punches in a number on her cell phone)* Yes – I'd like to inquire about a patient. Santiago Hernandez. . . I'm sorry I'm having trouble understanding your accent. *(beat)* He's no longer a patient? *(immensely relieved)* Thank you. Thank you so much. *(she hangs up)*

*******Scene *******

BOBBY: **(Pg 64-65)** So soon as we pay the hospital, you could take a break for a while. And soon as we get our papers, we go back to El Salvador together and get Tomas.

ANA: Gracias *(beat)* But I think he's better down there. With my grandmother. It's better.

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BOBBY: A grandmother is not a mother

ANA: Sometimes . . . a mother is not a mother.

BOBBY: Ana, please! It wasn't your fault.

ANA: *(after a beat)* If I'd picked him up . . . If I'd been there. Like a mother. Like any mother. *(Starts to break)* I never saw him play soccer. Did he play good? Did he look for me? I never saw him play!

BOBBY: *(Crying)* My son! Mi hijo. M'entiendes? Let him rest. *(through tears)* He's sleeping with the angels, Ana. Just like you always telling him!

ANA: *(singing)* Dueremete . . . Duermete con los angeles, mijo. *(She cries)*

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AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
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KS State Qualifier

TIP: Use Google Translate https://translate.google.com/ for Spanish phrases.

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